

Medford School Committee

Monday, January 24, 2022

Regular Meeting: 6:30 PM

**To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.
*Masks are required for in-person attendance.***

Also presented on Zoom:

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99048068111>

Meeting ID: 990 4806 8111

One tap mobile

+13126266799,,99048068111# US (Chicago)

+19292056099,,99048068111# US (New York)

Dial by your location

+1 312 626 6799 US (Chicago)

+1 929 205 6099 US (New York)

+1 301 715 8592 US (Washington DC)

Meeting ID: 990 4806 8111

Find your local number: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99048068111>

Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Organization of the School Committee: Election of School Committee Officers
- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Approval of Bills/Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 1.10.2022
- VI. Report of Subcommittees
- VII. Report of the Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. Introduction to the Equity Process - The Equity Process, a firm hired to conduct the Equity Audit of Medford Public Schools, will present the scope of work for MPS. - Ms. Cyndi Weekes-Bradley, CEO of The Equity Process, and Superintendent of Schools Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent.
3. COVID Update -Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy and Avery Hines Director of Health Services will report on operational updates and pending COVID shifts in the Medford Public Schools.
4. Midyear Update on Execution of the Strategic Plan- Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, will provide a mid-year update on the status of key initiatives.
5. Enrichment Program Overview: Camp Mustang to be offered February and April vacation in addition to Enrichment After School Programs K-12. Report presented by Assistant Superintendent of Elementary Education Suzanne Galusi, Assistant Superintendent of Secondary Education Dr. Peter Cusing, and Director of Pupil Services Joan Bowen.
6. Budget Update - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will provide an update on the Medford Public Schools budget.
7. Summer School Fees - Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will respond to Committee inquiry regarding Summer School Fee waivers.
8. MSBA Application- Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy will report on Medford High School and MSBA Application Deadline Update: The central administration will present on the recently announced application windows for the Massachusetts School Building Authority repair project windows opening January 28, 2022 and the administration plans to consider possible statements of interest through either or both of the Core Program or Accelerated Repair Program.

VIII. Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

“Regular Meetings of the School Committee include this ‘Presentations of the Public’ agenda item to give any resident the opportunity to place a presentation before the School Committee. A resident may only present once at any meeting.

These presentations are an opportunity for the public to make a presentation to the Committee but are not opportunities for dialog with the Committee. If one or more members of the Committee wishes to have a conversation about the topic presented, a member may request that the item be added to a subsequent Regular Meeting.

The details for submitting a presentation can be found within the policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public”

“Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their

comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. Residents may also submit their comments by writing to the Superintendent of Schools prior to the meeting, or by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us prior to or during the item on the agenda. Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee.

A welcoming inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective.

When writing or emailing, please provide this required information: 1) The number and name of the item on the agenda. 2) Your first and last name. 3) Your full Medford street address where you reside. 4) Your question or comment”

IX. Continued Business

1. Whereas students and families have been charged more than \$200 per class for summer remediation and credit recovery,

And whereas students enrolled in summer remediation and credit recovery are disproportionately more vulnerable subgroups, including economically disadvantaged students, students with disabilities and English learners,

Be it Resolved Medford Public Schools will no longer charge students identified as belonging in the subgroups, economically disadvantaged, English Learners and students with disabilities for remediation programming and credit recovery during summer programming and the academic year commencing June 1, 2022.

Be it further resolved that all students requiring credit remediation to prevent retention be notified in writing through the United States postage system and email 45 days before the last day of school.

- *Tabled from 1.10.2022*
- *Submitted by Member Melanie McLaughlin and Member Mea Mustone*

X. New Business

1. The Bullying Prevention and Intervention Plan will be reviewed by the Rules, Policy, and Equity Subcommittee for recommended updates.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

2. Policy BEDB - AGENDA CREATION AND FORMAT FOR REGULAR MEETINGS OF THE SCHOOL COMMITTEE will be amended by the insertion of the following text immediately following "New Business"

[Items on the agenda will be formatted as follows:

<New Business Item Number> - Offered by Member(s) <name(s)>

<text of motion or resolution>

Meeting Date Requested: <meeting date member asked to have this item on the agenda>

Submitted Date: <date submitted>

New Business Item Number will be formatted as: <year> - <number>. <year> will be the calendar year when the item was received by the Superintendent. New Business Item Number will be determined by the Superintendent's office and the number will reset to 1 for items received on or after January 1.

The Submitted Date is not the Meeting Date Requested but rather the date the item was emailed to the Superintendent and Chair. It is not uncommon for an item to be submitted well in advance of the actual meeting where the item is to be placed on the agenda, and items submitted may not be for the next meeting.

Example 1:

On August 21, 2021, Member Robert Smith submits a resolution for the meeting scheduled for October 1, 2021. The Superintendent determines this is the 114th item submitted in 2021:

2021-114 - Offered by Member Smith

Be it resolved that ...

Meeting Date Requested: October 1, 2021

Submitted Date: August 21, 2021

Example 2:

On January 1, 2022, Member Francis Roberts submits a resolution for the meeting scheduled for February 1, 2022. The Superintendent determines this is the 1st item submitted in 2022:

2022-1 - Offered by Member Roberts

Be it resolved that ...

Meeting Date Requested: February 1, 2022

Submitted Date: January 1, 2022]

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

3. Policy BEDB - Agenda Creation and Format for Regular Meetings of the School Committee containing language from Policy BEDH - Public Comment at School Committee Meetings, will be updated to reflect the changes approved in BEDH on January 10, 2022 by this body;

The language “Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. Residents may also submit their comments by writing to the Superintendent of Schools prior to the meeting, or by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us prior to or during the item on the agenda. Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee. A welcoming inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective. When writing or emailing, please provide this required information: 1) The number and name of the item on the agenda. 2) Your first and last name. 3) Your full Medford street address where you reside. 4) Your question or comment” will be replaced by:

“Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. A welcoming, inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective.” Further, the text “3. The Chair will ask the Vice-Chair, “Are there any other public comments you have received?” “If there are, they will be read.” will be deleted and item four (4) will be renumbered as three (3).

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

3. The Rules of the Medford School Committee have traditionally been passed down through the experience of members. While this has served us in the past, it is not best practice to have rules that are not written down for many reasons, such as the ability to bring new members into the committee efficiently, to ensure compliance and enforcement with our rules, agreement on what the rules are, provide transparency to the public on how we operate, to allow us to evolve our rules to improve over time, and provide a clear mechanism to respond to changes in the law that have an effect on our rules.

This has been a multi-year effort to discover best practices from other committees throughout Massachusetts, document the rules we have been operating under even when not written down, and bring these together to create a set of Rules for the Medford School Committee.

With this Rules document, we will have a place to begin. These rules should not be thought of as immutable, but rather offer us a common ground to improve the functioning of the Medford School Committee.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

5. Policy BEDC - QUORUM: Four members of the Committee shall constitute a quorum, but a smaller number may meet and adjourn from day to day.

Motion to repeal Quorum.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

6. Policy BDG - SCHOOL ATTORNEY - be referred to the Rules and Policy Subcommittee for recommended updates.

- *Offered by Member Paul Ruseau*

7. Whereas the Medford Public Schools is committed to understanding the needs of our diverse student population and supporting the social-emotional needs of our students;

Whereas the American Academy of Pediatrics, the American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, and the Children's Hospital Association have declared a national emergency in child and adolescent mental health;

Whereas the US Surgeon General issued an advisory outlining the devastating impact the COVID-19 pandemic has had and continues to have on the youth mental health crisis that existed prior to the pandemic; and

Whereas the effects of the pandemic have disproportionately affected students from racial and ethnic minorities, students with disabilities, LGBTQ+ students, and students from low income families;

Therefore, be it resolved that the administration will present at a regular school committee meeting, no later than 03/07/22, a detailed overview of the counseling/mental health supports currently available to students at all levels in the Medford Public Schools, including:

- titles and related job descriptions for positions that provide direct 1:1 or small group counseling to students;
- the number of staff currently in each position and their FTE at each school; current approximate hours spent in direct student contact for counseling (IEP services and non-IEP services);
- number of students at each school who have been referred for school-based individual or small group counseling (IEP and non-IEP);

- approximate number of non-IEP referrals that are on a “waitlist” for school-based counseling;
- number of students at each level who are referred for contracted mental health services outside of MPS;
- and the number of posted positions that remain unfilled.

Be it further resolved that the report will also outline recommended resources and staff required to meet the needs of the MPS student population beginning in the 2022-2023 school year.

- *Offered by Member Sharon Hays, Member Mea Mustone and Member Jenny Graham*

8. Whereas the Medford School Committee has contemplated the creation and deployment of a vision committee to ascertain and articulate the Medford community’s priorities and vision for Medford High School since 2019; and

Whereas Medford High School is a comprehensive high school serving approximately 1300 young adults of the Medford community charged with providing them with an engaging, well-rounded and culminating educational experience of their preK - 12+ academic careers and therefore serves as the flagship educational institution in which all members of the Medford community have a vested interest in its continuous improvement as a school; and

Whereas the establishment of the Medford High School vision committee has been delayed due to the ongoing challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic; and

Whereas the Medford School Committee recognizes that the deteriorating infrastructure of the current Medford High School demands urgent and bold action to ensure that current and future MHS students attend school in a building that is reflective of the Medford community’s deep and abiding commitment to education; and

Whereas the students of Medford High School are entitled to a 21st century education that is empowered through the utilization of best-in-class instructional technology and innovative practices; and

Whereas the Medford Public Schools are wholly committed to ensuring an equitable and inclusive process by which community representatives can deliberate over how to develop a vision that will ensure a flagship school that leaves Medford High School graduates poised for post-secondary life defined by happiness, success, and fulfillment; and

Whereas effective January 28, 2022 the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) will open both the Core Program and Accelerated Repair Program Statement of Interest application windows;

Therefore be it resolved that the Superintendent of Schools, utilizing an inclusive and equitable process by which to formulate a recommendation, will present to the Medford School Committee on March 21, 2022 a recommended course of action with respect to the MSBA sanctioned repair, rehabilitation, and/or rebuild processes.

Be it further resolved that as part of the Superintendent's presentation, the central administration will report on the deliberative process by which the recommendation to pursue either, both, or neither of the MSBA programs was established, including the stakeholders who were consulted, the school construction experts who were consulted, and the consensus if any about the strategic implications for the recommended course of action that developed through that process.

Be it further resolved that upon the Superintendent's recommendation, the Medford School Committee will convene, pursuant to School Committee Policy BDF, a Flagship Committee (formerly called the Medford High Vision Committee) comprised of representative stakeholders to deliberate over and make formal recommendations to the Medford School Committee about the organizing principles and core values that should be reflected in the district's flagship school regardless of whether the ultimate resolution to the MSBA application process is a new, refurbished, or extensively repaired Medford High School.

And be it further resolved that the Flagship Committee will convene to begin its work no later than April 4, 2022 and shall make progress reports to the Medford School Committee on a monthly basis for the duration of the term established when the Flagship Committee is formed.

- *Offered by Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, Member Paul Ruseau, and Member Jenny Graham*

XI. Reports Requested

XII. Condolences

XIII. Next Meeting

- **Monday, February 7, 2022: Regular School Committee Meeting** - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/95139729431>

XIV. Adjournment